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THE NZZ INTERVIEW

**"We are fundamentally
misunderstanding the
economic transition of this
decade."**

— Dr. Elena Rostova, Chief Economist



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*The narrative that
AI will simply
replace human
workers is
intellectually lazy.
The reality is far
more disruptive to
the European
middle class.*

DR. ELENA ROSTOVA



The White-Collar Shock



Unlike previous industrial revolutions that automated physical labor, the generative AI wave is squarely aimed at cognitive tasks.

Legal analysts, junior developers, and financial auditors are seeing their billable hours collapse.

Augmentation vs. Automation

The Optimists' View

AI acts as a "co-pilot," removing mundane administrative tasks and allowing humans to focus on high-level strategy.

The Pessimists' Reality

Companies won't reallocate saved time; they will simply reduce headcount. "Junior" training roles will vanish.



The Scope of Exposure

35%

OF EUROPEAN JOBS

Recent data from the ECB suggests that over a third of employment in the Eurozone is "highly exposed" to AI-driven automation.



What Policymakers Must Do

- **Taxing the algorithm:** Debates are intensifying around taxing AI productivity gains to fund universal basic income.
- **Redefining education:** Universities must pivot away from rote memorization towards critical thinking.
- **Protecting the social fabric:** Without intervention, wealth inequality will widen sharply.



Was ist deine Meinung?

Will AI destroy or create more jobs in the next
5 years?

Tell us in the comments.

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Image Sources



<https://ecfr.eu/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/Camille-Lons-300×300-c-center.jpg>

Source: ecfr.eu



<https://assets.insightmediagroup.io/media/wp-content/uploads/2026/03/image-140.jpg>

Source: towardsdatascience.com